

WINRAR



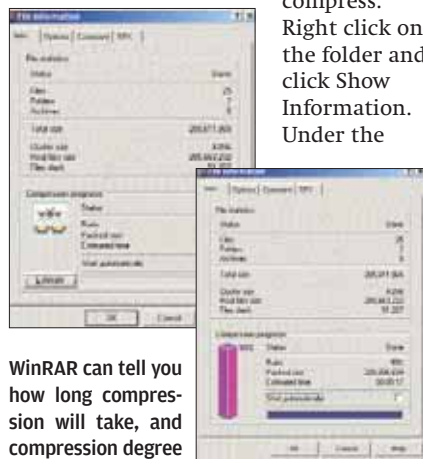
WinRAR has become everybody's favourite data compression tool mainly because of its support for many formats. WinZip and PowerArchiver have lost their charm as well: WinRAR stands out as a clean no-nonsense compression solution. We take a tour of some features you would normally not use.

Enable Explorer-like Folder View

WinRAR normally shows up a single pane view with the files and folders you last visited. There is no option to access your Desktop or any network shares. To gain access to them, you can choose to enable the two-pane view similar to that in Windows Explorer. Go to Options > Folder Tree > Show folder tree. To show all file details, you can click on Options > File List > Detail.

Get Compression Prognosis

Say you have a big file or a folder you want to compress, and you have no clue how long it will take or how much compression will actually take place. To get this rough idea, you can browse in WinRAR to the folder you plan to compress. Right click on the folder and click Show Information. Under the



WinRAR can tell you how long compression will take, and compression degree

Info tab, click on the Estimate button in the Compression prognosis section to get the information.

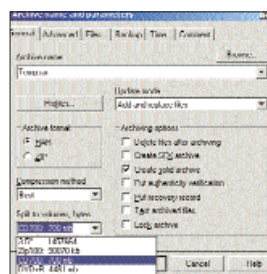
Customise Toolbar And Add Themes

WinRAR's toolbars can be customised to look a lot more attractive. First, there are skins you can download from www.rarlab.com/themes.htm. To install a theme, click on the Options menu bar and then on Themes > Organize Themes. Click on the Add button and select the downloaded theme. Then click on Options > Theme and choose the newly added theme.

You can choose to add some more buttons or remove unused ones by right-clicking on the toolbar and clicking on Select Buttons.

Use WinRAR To Split Files

WinRAR does more than just compress data. It can be used to split up big files so they fit on multiple CDs for mailing purposes. Choose a file or folder



Split files using WinRAR!

you want to split and choose to compress it by right-clicking on it, and clicking "Add files to archive". Click on the drop-down menu for "Split to

Make An SFX

volumes, bytes". Enter a value in KB or MB—or choose from one of the presets—and click OK.

Many a time, you end up sending files to people who don't use WinRAR or any compression tool for that matter. In such cases, it's best to convert your file to a self-extracting archive. Click on an existing archive and click on Tools > Convert archive to SFX. Choose one of the modules and click OK. A self-extracting archive will be created in the same folder. You can also create a SFX while compressing a file or folder by clicking on the Create SFX Archive checkbox.



Creating an SFX archive

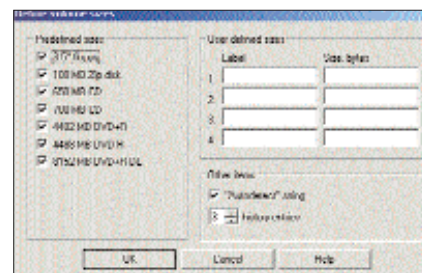
Create A Basic Installer Using WinRAR

Creating self-extracting archives gives you the option to create your own little

installer which uncompress an entire program to a set location. You can also choose to execute a program before or after the decompression process. Start by clicking on the folder you want to install, and click Add Files to archive. Check the "Create SFX archive" box. Click on the Advanced tab and then on "SFX options". Here you can enter the path you want the installer to unzip the files to, and whether you want the folder created in Program files or some other folder. You'll find many other options here to customise the installer, such as adding shortcuts or licensing information.

Additional Splitting Sizes

During the compressing and splitting process, you can choose from the presets what size you want your archives to be split. Additional presets



"Define volume sizes" lets you add more presets

can be added by clicking on Options > Settings. Click on the Compression tab and click the Define volume sizes button. You can check the boxes not checked to add those volume presets. At the same time, you can add your own presets under the "User defined sizes" section.

Compress And Mail

A feature called Compress and mail, which lets you directly compress a folder and e-mail it to anyone, is normally hidden. You can make it visible by clicking on the Options menu and then on Settings. Click on the Integration tab and then the Context menu items. Here, check the checkboxes for "Compress and mail" and "Compress to <archive name> and mail".

Change The Temp Folder

By default, the temporary files created by WinRAR are stored in the C:\Documents and Settings\USERNAME\Local Settings\Temp folder. If you are short on space on your Windows partition, you might want to move your temporary folder elsewhere.

Click on Options > Settings, and then on the Paths tab. Click the "Choose Folder for temporary files" section and select a path of your choice. ☑